15.2.1 Uses of Natural Gas

- Natural gas is used as an industrial and domestic fuel.
- It is used in thermal power stations.
- It is used as fuel in vehicles as an alternative for petrol and diesel.
- When heated it decomposes and forms hydrogen and carbon. Hydrogen thus formed is used in the manufacture of fertilizers.
- It is used to manufacture chemicals, fabrics, glass, steel, plastics and paints.
- It is also used in electricity generation.



Figure 15.5 Uses of natural gas

DO YOU KNOW?

Moderate temperature and humidity is needed to keep paintings and other ancient artifacts from being destroyed by environmental factors. Thus natural gas is used in museums to protect the monuments.

15.2.2 Advantages of Natural Gas

- It produces lot of heat as it can be easily burnt.
- It does not leave any residue.
- It burns without smoke and so causes no pollution.
- This can be easily supplied through pipes.
- It can be directly used as fuel in homes and industries.

15.2.3 Compressed Natural Gas

When the natural gas is compressed at high pressure, it is called Compressed Natural Gas (CNG). Nowadays it is used as fuel in automobiles. The primary hydrocarbon present in CNG is methane (88.5%). Natural gas is liquefied for shipping in large tankers. This is called Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG). CNG is stored at high pressure whereas LNG is stored in ultra cold liquid form. CNG has the following properties.

- It is the cheapest and cleanest fuel.
- Vehicles using this gas produce less carbon dioxide and hydrocarbon emission.
- It is less expensive than petrol and diesel.

More to Know

The average composition of CNG.

Constituents	Percentage
Methane	88.5
Ethane	5.5
Propane	3.7
Butane	1.8
Pentane	0.5

15.3 Other Gases

Apart from natural gas, there are some other gases which are used as fuel. Producer gas, coal gas, bio gas and water gas are some of them.

Producer Gas

Producer gas is a gaseous mixture of carbon monoxide and nitrogen. It is produced by passing air mixed with steam, over red hot coke at a temperature of 1100 °C. It is used as an industrial fuel for iron and steel manufacturing.

DO YOU KNOW?

Producer gas is known by different names in different countries. It is referred as Wood gas in USA and as Suction gas in UK.

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